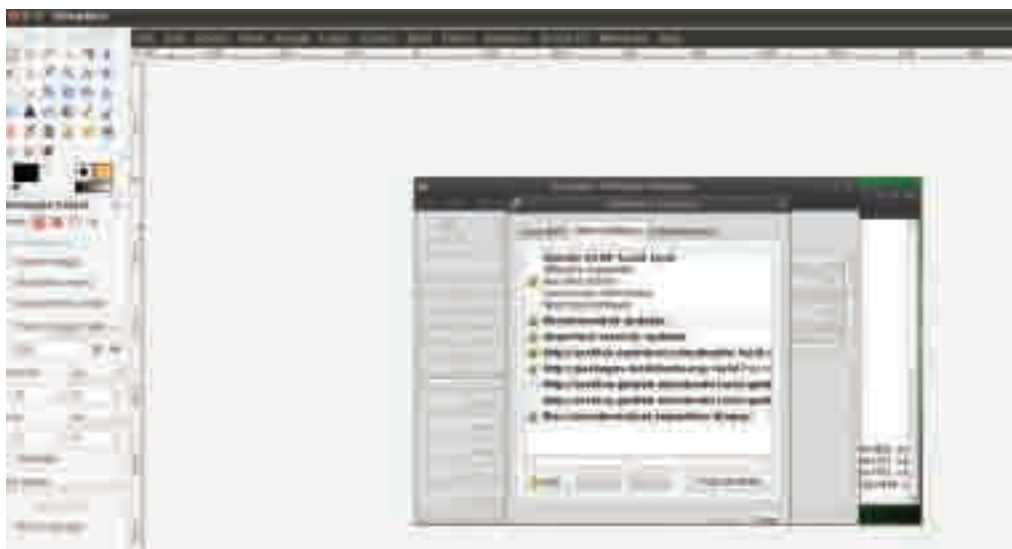




A more organised GIMP

You can press [Ctrl] + [F] to repeat the last filter, very helpful when batch processing images, and to save some space you can press [Ctrl] + [E] to shrink wrap your window to the size of the image.

GimpBox

A common complaint that many users have (especially those migrating from Photoshop) is that Gimp opens a separate windows which float independently around. You can of course fix this by using GimpShop (<http://www.gimpshop.com/>) which will make your GIMP look exactly like Photoshop including menu structure, but then it is proper fork of the GIMP project. If you just want a single window mode, then you can use a simple python script called 'GimpBox', you can download it from <http://wgethttp://gimpbox.google-code.com/hg/gimpbox.py> Linux user don't forget it grant it Executable permissions [From the terminal, in the directory where it is located, simple type `chmod +x gimpbox.py`. Further detailed instructions can be found at <http://ranjith.zfs.in/gimpbox-gimp-in-single-window-for-gimp-2-6-10-or-older-gimp/>.

Windows Live Movie Maker

With the advent of Microsoft's Windows Live services and products; came Windows Live Movie Maker (WLMM) which replaces the Windows Movie Maker that was in versions of Windows prior to Windows 7. WLMM is Video editing software focusing towards basic video manipulation requirements of a general user. WLMM 2011 is provided as a part of the Windows Live Essentials 2011, available for download at <http://download.live.com/moviemaker>. The installation of WLMM necessitates the installation of Windows Live Photo Gallery. Some of the things a user can do using WLMM are:

- Adding videos and photos: You can start your project by adding videos or photos from your collection in one of the compatible formats of WLMM. This can be added directly into the Movie Maker or through the Windows Live Photo Gallery.
- Personalise your movie with various transitions and effects like pan and zoom effects, visual effects, titles, credits, captions etc.
- Integrating sound tracks from your music collection and other sound files.
- Quick movie generation

using the AutoMovie themes which automatically adds a title, credits, transitions, and effects for you.

- Preview your movie at any time midway during the project creation, or any segment of the movie.
- Share the movie on the web by publishing your movie on sites like YouTube, Facebook, Windows Live SkyDrive, or through plugins provided by other sites.
- Burn your movie directly to DVD using Movie Maker.

User Interface

WLMM user interface includes the ribbon interface (also known as the Fluent User Interface introduced in Microsoft Office 2007) that helps users find commands directly with least clicks minimizing the necessity of trial-and-error usage or Help referencing.

The ribbon consolidates the functionality previously found in menus and toolbars; which improves the speed with which an average user can create / edit videos.

Essentials of Producing a Movie

Adding Videos and Photos
Add videos or photos by clicking on the "Add videos

and photos" option in the Add group and selecting the file of your choice by navigating to the folder with your collection. You can select multiple photos or videos by holding the [Ctrl] key, and then selecting the respective files.

You can quickly add photos and video files to the WLMM project by dragging the files from its folder location.

Trimming Video

If you want only some sections of your video to be retained in your project, you can trim the beginning and end of a video so your project shows only the part of the video you want. For example, you can remove the blank frames in a movie by trimming. Trimming a video in WLMM environment does not affect the original file.

Trimming can be done by selecting the 'Trim Tool' from the 'Editing' group of the 'Edit' tab on the ribbon. You can set the exact start and end points for the segment you want. Remember to 'Save Trim' before exiting.

When you edit a video file in WLMM, the original video file isn't affected. All the video footage remains in the original video file. You can quickly trim the video by pressing the 'I' key which makes the current point as the start point on your project, pressing 'O' makes it the end point. 'Split' option breaks the video at the pointer location, you can also use key-stroke 'M' for splitting a video into two segments.

Clear any new start and end points in Movie maker to make the entire video to play from the Trim Tool by dragging the start trim handle to the beginning of the video to make it play from the beginning, or the end trim handle to the end of the video to make it play to the end; from the point of trim.